

Clearnet (networking)

Clearnet is a term that typically refers to the publicly accessible Internet. Sometimes *clearnet* is used as a synonym for *surface web*—excluding both *darknets* and the *deep web*. The *World Wide Web* is one of the most popular distributed services on the Internet, and the surface web is composed of the web pages and databases that are indexed by traditional *search engines*.

Clearnet can be seen as the opposite of *darknet*, which typically describes the services built on *Tor* or other anonymity networks, the connection to which is encrypted and anonymized.^[1] Because the darknet is not publicly accessible, it is part of the deep web. The term *deep web* describes those parts of the Internet that are not indexed, whether or not they are publicly accessible. It includes web portals to databases that require text searches, and interactive web sites that require more user input than simply clicking hyperlinks.^[2]



Surface web in relation to deep web and dark web

Characteristics

Without the use of anonymity services like *Tor*, browsing the clearnet is typically not anonymous; most websites routinely identify users by their *IP addresses* as well as other data transmitted by the client.^[3]

References

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